

Organization and Management Exam Notes

ME 708 · IV-I (BEL, BEX, BCT, BEI) · TU, IOE · tiers over 29 papers, 2065–2082 BS

4. Case Studies

2 hrs · asked in **14 of 29 papers** · 5 syllabus topics · **92 marks, 3.9% of the archive** → small, but a near-certain 4-mark short note since 2079.

READ THIS FIRST

Only two things are ever asked, in rotation: **objectives of case study** (8 papers) and **steps / phases of case study** (5 papers, all since 2079). Learn the **6 steps** and the **5 phases** as two separate numbered lists; examiners use both words. Twice a paper has set an applied 8-marker (prepare a case study of NEA or Nepal Telecom; recommend improvements for your college): answer it by filling in the **report structure** of §4.3. §4.4 and §4.5 are those two cases **written out in full**, as models. Tier chips count **papers out of 29**: **TOP n/29** 8+ **HOT n/29** 4–7 **PIN n/29** 1–3 inside an 8-mark question. Bold year = Regular exam.

4.1 Introduction and Objectives

What is a case study? Why are case studies conducted? Objectives and value of case study **2 3 4**

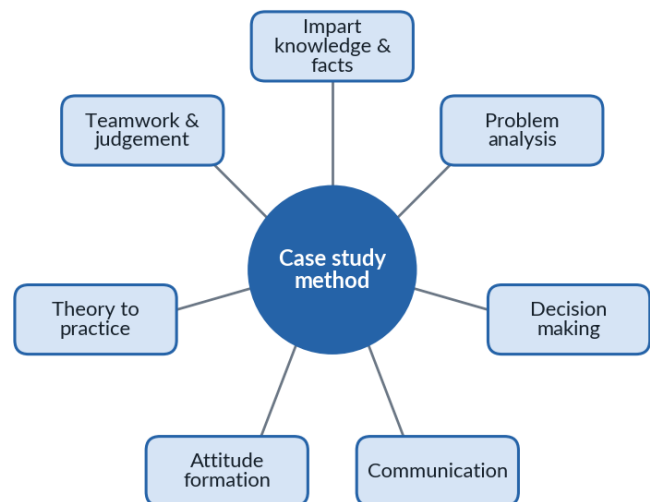
TOP 8/29 81 Ba, 80 Ba, 73 Ch, 71 Ch, 71 Shr, 70 Asa, 69 Ch, 66 Bh · short note in 71 Shr, 69 Ch, 66 Bh ("value of case study")

Meaning

- A **case** = written description of a **real management situation**: facts, reports, even opinions, but **no evaluation**.
- **Case study method**: learners analyse the case, identify problems, weigh alternatives and **decide**, as a manager would.
- Belief behind it: managerial competence comes from studying and discussing **actual situations**, not only theory.
- Word means different things to different users:
 - lawyer: a legal case;
 - researcher: a vehicle for **testing a hypothesis**;
 - management education: an **authentic problem** to train analysis and decision making.
- Aim secured by facing the learner with a **whole series** of cases, not one.
- Harvard Business School made it the standard method of management teaching (1920s) **verified/added**.

Why conducted (AJ Sir)

- Teach managerial skills: **analyse** a situation, **frame** the right questions, **find answers**, **make decisions**.
- Link the three foundations of management practice: **research, theory, practice**.



Objectives

1. **Impart knowledge and facts** about real organizations.
2. Develop **problem analysis** skill: separate symptoms from causes.
3. Develop **decision-making** skill under incomplete information.
4. Improve **communication**: discuss, defend, write reports.
5. Shape **attitude**: nothing in human behaviour is absolutely right or wrong; respect other views.
6. Apply **theory to practice**; test principles against reality.
7. Build **teamwork** and judgement through group discussion.

Value (short note, 66 Bh)

- + realistic, active learning.
- + develops analytical thinking; learner participates.
- + many solutions welcome → no single “right” answer.
- + bridges classroom and industry.
- time consuming: gathering, arranging and writing up the facts is long and tedious (Adhikari).
- needs a skilled discussion leader.
- one case may not generalize.

Types of case studies 2

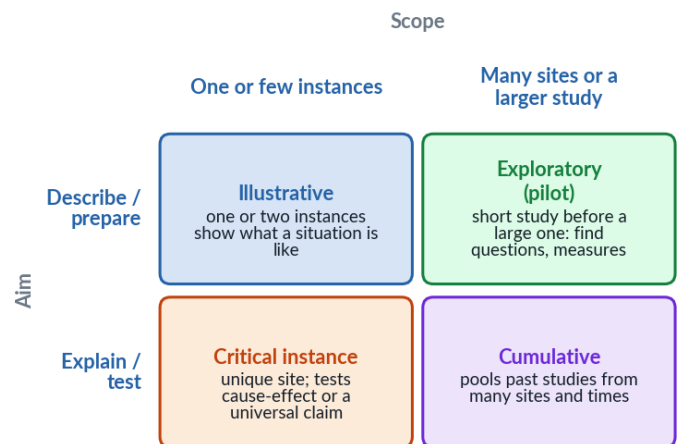
PIN 1/29 80 Ba

- Illustrative:** descriptive; one or two instances show what a situation is like; makes the unfamiliar familiar; gives readers a common language.
- Exploratory (pilot):** short study before a large investigation, to find the right questions and measures. Risk: early findings released as conclusions.
- Cumulative:** combines past studies from several sites and times → wider generalization at no new cost.
- Critical instance:** one or a few sites of unique interest, or to challenge a universal claim; answers cause-effect questions.

Teaching cases may also be classed as **incident** (short event), **problem / decision** (choose an action), **appraisal** (evaluate a situation) and **descriptive** cases.

Case study vs lecture verified/added

	Lecture	Case study
Learner	listens	analyses, decides
Content	principles	real situation
Answer	one correct	several defensible
Skill built	recall	judgement, communication



4.2 Phases and Steps of Case Study

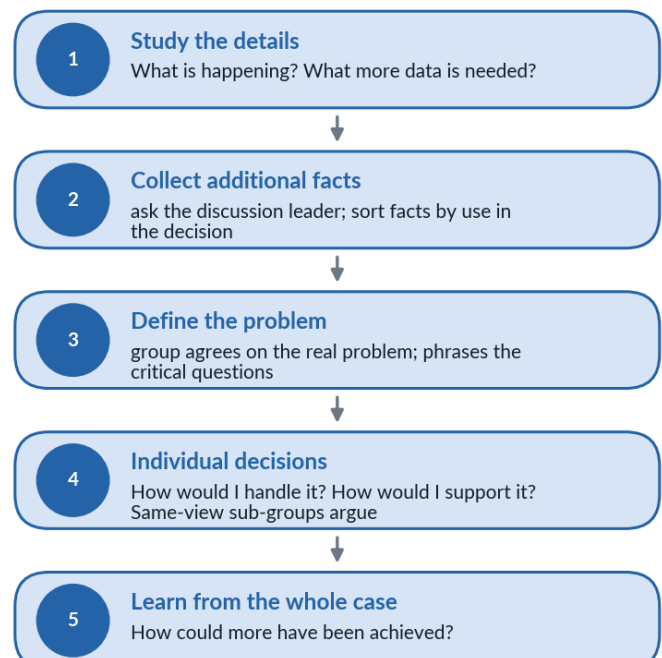
Explain the phases and steps of case study, with an example from your field 4 5 8

HOT 5/29 82 Bh, 81 Bh, 81 Ba, 80 Bh, 79 Bh · short note in 82 Bh, 81 Bh · every paper since 2079 except 80 Ba

Five phases (group discussion)

- Study the details:** each member reads the case.
 - What is happening, or has happened?
 - What additional data are essential?
- Collect additional facts:** ask the discussion leader for details; organize facts by relevance to the decision.
- Define the problem:** the group agrees on the real problem and phrases the critical questions (some cases supply the questions).
- Individual decisions:** each writes “How would I handle it? How would I support my decision?”
 - members with the same view form sub-groups;
 - each sub-group presents its strongest argument; decisions discussed.
- Learn from the whole case:** “How could more have been achieved?”

Five phases (group discussion)



Six steps (individual analysis)

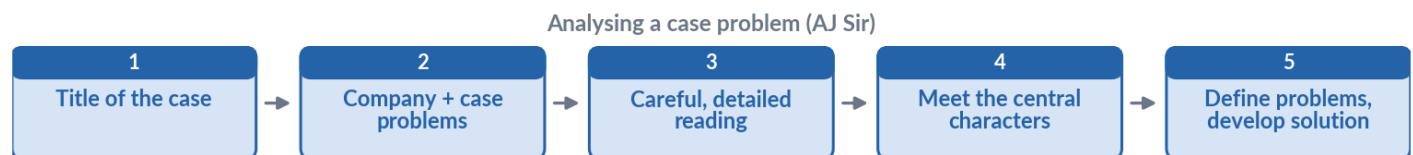
1. **State the problem:** after reading the case and its questions, write what the case is about, what must be done, what action taken, what answered.
2. **Collect and analyse data:** arrange facts systematically; separate facts from opinions.
3. **Formulate tentative solutions:** treat first ideas as tentative; list all alternatives and give each due consideration.
4. **Select the recommended solution:** one solution, the best answer to the stated problem on the given data.
5. **Prepare the written report.**
6. **Checklist:** are you going in the right direction?
 - what does the solution achieve?
 - what difficulties must be overcome?
 - what limits (time, money, equipment, manpower)?
 - is it the best alternative?

A solution that fails the checklist sends you back to step 3.

Phases vs steps: which to write

- **Phases** = how a **group** works through a case in a class or workshop (discussion method).
- **Steps** = how **one analyst** solves it and writes it up (report method).
- Question says “phases” → 5 phases; “steps” → 6 steps; “phases and steps” (81 Bh) → both lists, 2 marks each.
- Always add one line of example from engineering (below).

Analysing a case problem (AJ Sir): the reading order before step 1



Example from engineering: why did a hydropower project finish two years late? verified/added

Step	Applied
1 State the problem	60 MW project, planned 4 years, took 6; cost overrun 40%. Why, and how to prevent it next time?
2 Collect and analyse data	Schedule vs actual (Gantt), change orders, land-acquisition dates, contractor payments, site logs, interviews with engineers and locals. Finding: land dispute (8 months), tunnel geology surprise (10 months), late payments → contractor slowdown.
3 Tentative solutions	(a) better geological survey; (b) settle land before tender; (c) escrow payment to contractor; (d) matrix project organization with one accountable manager.
4 Recommended solution	Combine (a)+(b) as pre-construction gates, (c) for cash flow; (d) as the structure.
5 Written report	Background, problem, data, analysis, recommendations, implementation plan.
6 Checklist	Achieves on-time completion; needs upfront survey budget; limit: political land issues; still the best alternative.

4.3 Case Report Writing, and Preparing a Case Study

Prepare a case study of an organization (NEA / Nepal Telecom; your college) following the case structure **8**

PIN 2/29 74 Ch, 72 Ch · applied 8-markers: fill in the structure · full models in §4.4 (72 Ch) and §4.5 (74 Ch)

Case report writing methodology (Adhikari)

1. **Organizational background:**
 - goals and objectives; formation;
 - structure; social needs and value;
 - historical relation; financial position.
2. **Identification of the problem.**
3. **Hypothesis:** the suspected cause.
4. **Case research design:** what data, from whom, how.
5. **Collection and analysis of data.**
6. **Generalization and interpretation.**
7. **Conclusions and recommendations.**

Typical report titles (a full O&M case study)

1. Acknowledgement.
2. Organization: history, objectives, input, process, output.
3. Organization structure (chart).
4. Form of ownership.
5. Personnel policies; manpower planning.
6. Recruitment and selection; training and development.
7. Job evaluation; merit rating; wages and incentives.
8. Motivation; marketing; leadership; MIS.
9. Drawbacks; suggestions and recommendations.
10. Conclusion; references.

The titles are the syllabus itself: a case study is where Ch. 1–3 and 5 are applied to one real organization.

Writing the 8-mark version in the exam

- Use the **7 headings** of the methodology as your headings; 1–3 lines each.
- Spend the marks on **what the question names**: 72 Ch names planning horizon, leadership, motivation, HRD → one analysis paragraph each.
- Give **one or two real numbers** (loss %, load-shedding hours, pass rate); they show the data step was done.
- Draw **one** figure: an org chart, a cause-and-effect (fishbone) diagram, or a time-bound plan.
- End with **recommendations + time frame**, then the **checklist** line (achieves, difficulties, limits, best alternative).
- Roughly: background 1, problem + hypothesis 1, design + data 2, analysis 2, recommendations 2 marks.

4.4 Mock Case Study 1: Nepal Electricity Authority (72 Ch)

PIN 1/29 72 Ch · written out in full as a model · figures are NEA's published figures; staff-survey results are illustrative **verified/added**

Question (72 Ch, 8 marks)

If you are asked to prepare the case study considering the planning horizon, leadership, motivation and human resource development for either Nepal Electricity Authority or Nepal Telecom to improve the existing performance of these institutions, how do you prepare the case study following its structure?

Title

Improving the performance of Nepal Electricity Authority: a case study of planning horizon, leadership, motivation and human resource development. Period studied: FY 2072/73 (the crisis year) to FY 2080/81.

Acknowledgement

1. Organizational background	2. Case study report
Goals and objectives	Identify the problem
Formation	Develop the hypothesis
Structure	Case research design
Social needs and value	Collect + analyse data
Historical relation	Generalize + interpret
Financial position	Conclusions + recommendations

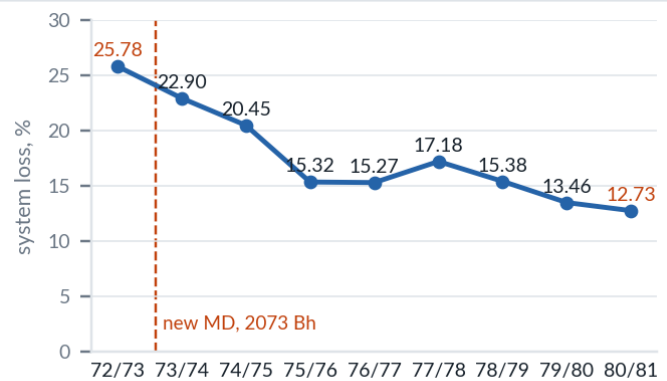
Thanks to NEA's Planning, Monitoring and IT Directorate for the annual reports, to the distribution-centre chiefs who gave interviews, and to the course teacher for guidance.

1. Organizational background

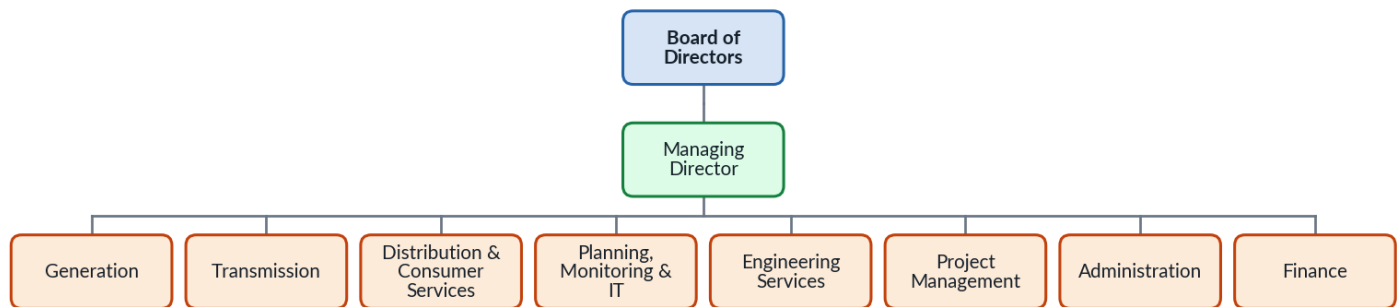
- **Formation:** established 16 August 1985 (Bhadra 1, 2042) under the **NEA Act 2041**, merging the Electricity Department, Nepal Electricity Corporation and related development boards.
- **Form of ownership:** **public corporation**, fully government owned (§1.4): own legal entity, govt control, service + commercial motive.
- **Goals:** generate, transmit and distribute adequate, reliable and affordable power; plan and develop the national grid; trade power with India.
- **Structure:** Board of Directors chaired by the Energy Minister → Managing Director → Deputy Managing Directors heading functional directorates (figure) → regional offices and distribution centres. A **line and staff** structure (§1.5).
- **Social value:** power drives industry, health, education, irrigation, telecom; every household is a customer.
- **Financial position:** accumulated loss of **Rs 34.61 bn** up to FY 2072/73; first net profit **Rs 1.46 bn** in FY 2073/74, profitable every year since.

Input, process, output

Stage	NEA
Input	water (river flow), own plants, power bought from IPPs, imports from India, staff, capital, tariff revenue
Process	generation → transmission (132/220/400 kV) → distribution → metering and billing
Output	electricity to domestic, industrial, commercial consumers; export in the wet season; revenue



FY (BS). Source: NEA figures reported in Kathmandu Post 2017 and Khabarhub 2024.



NEA organization structure (simplified to directorate level).

2. Identification of the problem

- In FY 2072/73 NEA showed every sign of a failing public enterprise:
 - **load-shedding** up to **18 hours a day** in the dry winter;
 - **system loss 25.78%**: a quarter of energy lost, much of it theft;
 - accumulated **loss Rs 34.61 bn**; industries on diesel generators;
 - low staff morale; public anger.
- **Problem statement**: why did NEA perform so poorly, and what should it do in planning, leadership, motivation and HRD to improve?

3. Hypothesis

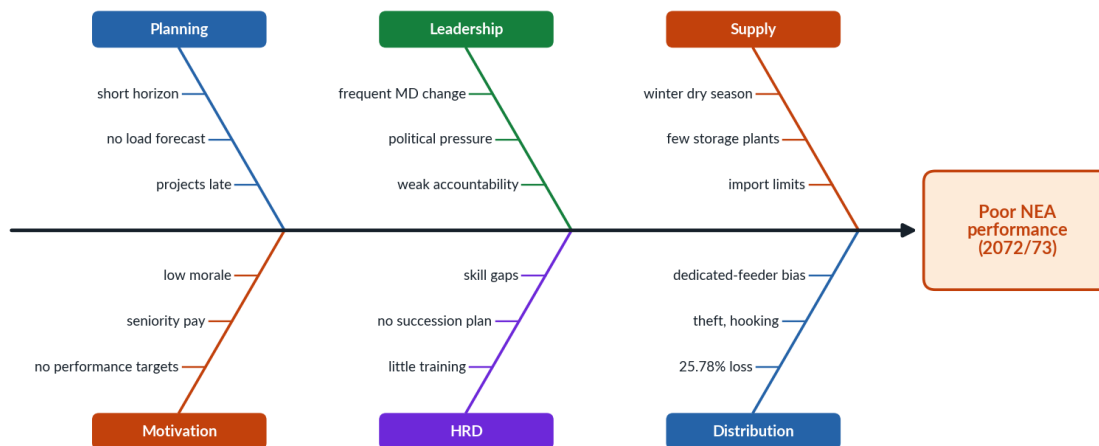
- **Main**: poor performance is as much a **management** failure as a shortage of generation.
- H1: planning horizon was short → fire-fighting, no storage.
- H2: leadership was weak and unstable → no accountability.
- H3: staff lacked motivators → leakage tolerated.
- H4: HRD was neglected → skill gaps in new technology.

4. Case research design

Data	Source and method
Secondary	NEA annual reports FY 2072/73–2080/81: loss, demand, supply, finance; news reports
Interviews	20 officers: MD office, 2 directorates, 6 distribution centres
Staff survey	200 staff, 5-point scale: pay, recognition, training, leadership
Consumer survey	300 households and 30 industries: supply hours, complaints
Observation	2 substations and 1 control centre (dispatch)
Analysis	trend charts; before/after 2073; fishbone of causes

5. Collection and analysis of data

System loss fell **25.78** (72/73) → **22.90** → **20.45** → **15.32** → **15.27** → **17.18** (COVID year) → **15.38** → **13.46** → **12.73%** (80/81). Each point of loss is roughly a billion rupees a year: NEA says leakage control earns it about Rs 12 bn a year.



Cause-and-effect analysis of NEA's performance in FY 2072/73.

(a) Planning horizon

- Found: planning mostly **short term**, one dry season at a time.
- Storage and peaking plants delayed for years → winter deficit grew with demand.
- Fix by three horizons:
 - **short** (1 yr): manage peak, cut leakage, import in winter;
 - **medium** (2–5 yr): transmission lines and substations, smart meters;
 - **long** (10–20 yr): storage projects, cross-border lines, export.
- H1 **accepted**.

(b) Leadership

- A new MD took charge on 14 Sept 2016 (Bhadra 2073).
- Within about two months Kathmandu Valley was declared load-shedding free (Tihar, Oct 2016); nationwide by **May 2018**.
- Mostly the **same** generation capacity: the change came from **dispatch management**, ending **dedicated-feeder** privileges, leakage raids, peak-hour imports.
- Style: high concern for task **and** people → 9,9 team management on Blake–Mouton's grid (§3.3); visible, decisive, accountable.
- H2 **accepted**: leadership was the turning factor.

6. Generalization and interpretation

- The turnaround came **before** big new plants: management, not only megawatts, explains most of it → main hypothesis supported.
- Supply growth (new plants, imports) then made the gains last.
- **Generalization**: other Nepali public enterprises (Nepal Telecom, Nepal Airlines, Nepal Oil Corporation) can improve the same way: stable accountable leadership, performance targets, a long planning horizon, merit-based HRD.
- **Limit**: the gains depend on one leader unless built into systems; political interference is the main risk.

(c) Motivation

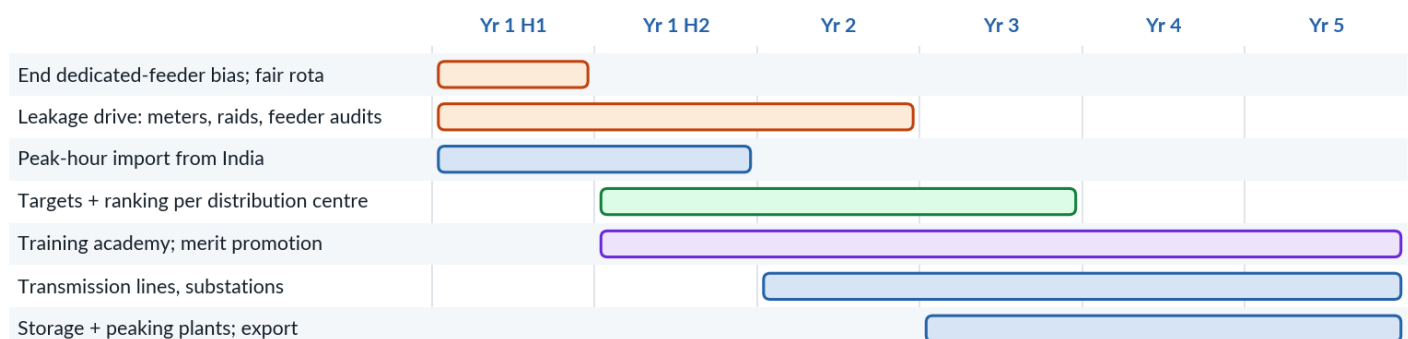
- Staff survey (illustrative): pay and job security rated fair; recognition and growth rated poor.
- Herzberg (§3.2): **hygiene** factors present, **motivators** absent → no dissatisfaction, but no drive either.
- What worked: loss **targets per distribution centre**, monthly ranking, public recognition, action against poor performers.
- Maslow: esteem needs met by recognition; Vroom: effort → visible result → reward raised expectancy.
- H3 **accepted**.

(d) Human resource development

- Found: little structured training; promotion by seniority; no succession plan.
- New needs: smart metering, SCADA, grid operation, cross-border trade, project management.
- Needed: training-needs analysis (§2.4), skill-based training, merit rating linked to promotion, succession planning for key posts.
- H4 **partly accepted**: training exists but is not tied to career growth.

7. Conclusions and recommendations

Area	Recommendation	Horizon
Planning	rolling 1/5/20-year plan; load forecast; storage first	all three
Leadership	fixed MD tenure; performance contract with the Board	short
Motivation	loss and service targets per centre; ranking, rewards	short
HRD	needs analysis; training academy; merit promotion; succession	medium
Technology	smart meters, SCADA, MIS dashboards (§5)	medium
Governance	shield operations from political transfers	long



Time-bound implementation plan (H1, H2 = first and second half-year).

Checklist (step 6)

- **Achieves:** reliable supply, loss near 10%, sustained profit, motivated staff.
- **Difficulties:** union resistance to performance ranking; political transfers.
- **Limits:** capital for storage plants; dry-season hydrology; import capacity.
- **Best alternative?** Yes: cheaper and faster than building capacity alone.

4.5 Mock Case Study 2: Recommendations to Your College (74 Ch)

PIN 1/29 74 Ch · written out in full as a model · “XYZ Engineering Campus” and all its numbers are illustrative; put your own campus’s facts in **verified/added**

Question (74 Ch, 8 marks)

Having spent more than 3 years in a particular college/campus of yours, what are the recommendations you wish to propose to the college management for the future improvement that would in turn boost up overall academic performance and image of the college?

1. Organizational background

- **XYZ Engineering Campus**, affiliated to TU, IOE; founded 2060 BS; private (company-owned) college.
- **Programmes:** BCT, BEI, BEL, BCE; about 960 students, 72 faculty (40 full time).
- **Goal:** produce competent engineers; top-10 IOE results; placement.
- **Structure:** Board → Principal → Heads of Department, Exam Section, Admin and Accounts (line and staff).
- **Financial position:** fee-funded; stable, little surplus for labs.

2. Identification of the problem

- Board pass rate fell from 74% to 62% over three years.
- Admissions fell 15%; few campus placements.
- **Problem:** what should management change to raise academic performance and the college’s image?

3. Hypothesis

- Weak results come mainly from **faculty instability** and **poor facilities**, not from weaker students.

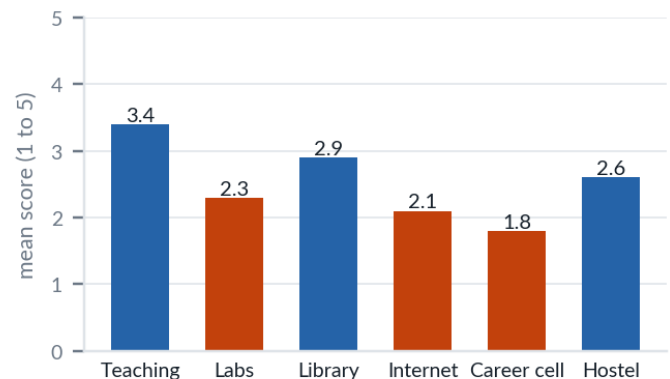
Drawbacks of this study; references

- Survey figures are illustrative; a real study would sample properly.
- References: NEA annual reports; Kathmandu Post (2016, 2017, 2019); Khabarhub (2024).

4. Case research design

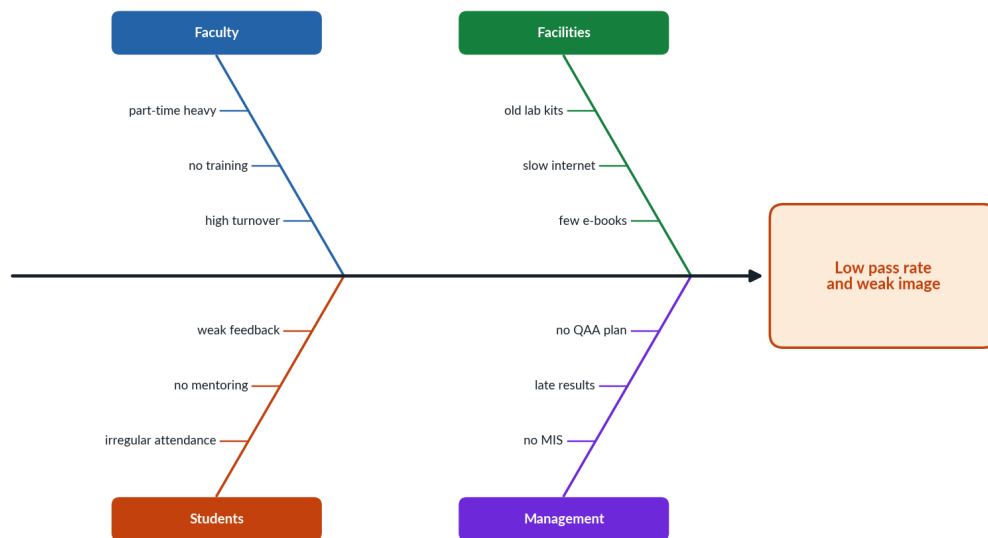
Data	Source and method
Records	3 years of results, attendance, faculty turnover, admissions
Survey	240 students, 5-point scale on six areas
Interviews	12 faculty, 3 HoDs, the principal
Observation	labs, library, internet, hostel
Benchmark	two better-ranked IOE colleges

5. Collection and analysis of data



Illustrative survey of 240 students; orange = below 2.5, act first.

- Lowest: **career cell 1.8, internet 2.1, labs 2.3**; library 2.9 and hostel 2.6 middling; teaching 3.4 is the strongest area.
- Faculty turnover 25% a year; 45% of classes taken by part-timers.
- Students with over 80% attendance passed at 81%; the rest at 44%.



Cause-and-effect analysis: why results and image are falling.

6. Generalization and interpretation

- Attendance and faculty stability explain most of the pass-rate gap → hypothesis supported.
- Facilities (labs, internet) hurt practical courses and the college's image.
- Image follows results and placement: fix those, then publicize.
- Holds for most private affiliated colleges: **people and systems** before buildings.

Checklist

- Achieves:** higher pass rate, stronger admissions, better placement.
- Difficulties:** cost of full-time faculty; staff resistance to evaluation.
- Limits:** fee ceiling; TU calendar; space.
- Best alternative:** yes, most items cost little and repay through admissions.

7. Recommendations (by priority)

Area	Recommendation	When
Faculty	more full-time posts; training; merit-based pay and promotion	1 yr
Academic	attendance rule; mentoring; internal tests; remedial classes	now
Labs	replace kits; lab manuals; industry-sponsored labs	1–2 yr
Library, IT	e-journals; campus Wi-Fi; LMS for notes and assignments	1 yr
Students	career cell, internships, alumni talks, clubs	now
Research	small grants; MoUs with industry; project exhibitions	2 yr
Management	MIS for attendance, results, feedback; UGC QAA accreditation	1–3 yr
Image	website, social media, results and placement publicity	ongoing

Close: "Priorities 1–2 first; review every semester with student feedback."

4.6 PYQ Mapping

Theory questions, covered in this document

- What is a case study, why conducted, objectives, value → §4.1. 8 papers; three of them as a 4-mark short note.
- Types of case studies 80 Ba 2 → §4.1.
- Phases and steps, with an example from your field → §4.2. 82 Bh 4, 81 Bh 4, 81 Ba 5, 80 Bh 8, 79 Bh 8
- Prepare a case study of NEA / Nepal Telecom 72 Ch 8 → §4.3 structure, §4.4 full model.
- Recommendations for your college 74 Ch 8 → §4.3 structure, §4.5 full model.
- 73 Ch and 71 Ch pair case-study objectives with MIS needs; the MIS half is in Ch. 5.

Numerical content

- This chapter has no numerical component.

Sources

- Adhikari pp259–272 and AJ Sir's 7-slide deck cover all five syllabus topics between them. S.K. Joshi's textbook follows an older syllabus and has no case-study chapter, so nothing was taken from it here.
- No local source has a case-study diagram: every figure in this chapter is generated (ch4fig.py) from the lists printed here.

- NEA facts: NEA annual reports as reported by Kathmandu Post (16 Aug 2016, 18 Aug 2017, 15 Feb 2019) and Khabarhub (Nov 2024).

Abbreviations, chips and month codes

Only these are ever shortened. Anything not on this list is written out in full.

Short	Means	Short	Means
JSC	joint stock company	MNC	multinational company
HR, HRM	human resource (management)	OB	organizational behaviour
MBO	management by objectives	CEO, MD	chief executive officer, managing director
AGM	annual general meeting	ESOP	employee share ownership plan
MoA, AoA	memorandum / articles of association	OCR	Office of the Company Registrar
SEBON	Securities Board of Nepal	NEPSE	Nepal Stock Exchange
IPO	initial public offering	PAN, VAT	permanent account no., value added tax
NEA	Nepal Electricity Authority	NOC	Nepal Oil Corporation
QC	quality control	R&D	research and development
OR	operations research	ROI	return on investment
CIM	computer integrated manufacturing	FMS	flexible manufacturing system
CAD, CAM	computer aided design / manufacturing	CAPP	computer aided process planning
CNC	computer numerical control	AGV	automated guided vehicle
MIS	management information system	IT	information technology
SaaS	software as a service	BPO	business process outsourcing
CSR	corporate social responsibility	POSDCoRB	plan, organize, staff, direct, coordinate, report, budget

Short	Means	Short	Means
no.	number	info	information
vs, Vs	versus	Eg	example / for example
+Fig	draw a figure	(I)	importance / need / significance
→	leads to / therefore	+	and
=	is / equals	min, max	minimum, maximum
Ch.	chapter	§	section

Chip	Means (29 papers, 2065–2082 BS)
TOP n/29	asked in 8 or more papers
HOT n/29	asked in 4 to 7 papers
PIN n/29	asked in 1 to 3 papers, inside an 8-mark question
LOW n/29	asked in 1 to 3 papers, as a 4-mark short note only
syllabus, no PYQ yet	in the syllabus, never examined
4+4	marks as printed; several chips = the question recurred at different marks
verified/added	researched and added beyond the lecture notes
80 Bh	bold year = Regular exam; plain = Back exam

Months: Ba = Baishakh, Jth = Jestha, Asa = Ashad, Shr = Shrawan, Bh = Bhadra, Ash = Ashwin, Ka = Kartik, Mng = Mangsir, Po = Poush, Ma = Magh, Ch = Chaitra. **Ash and Asa are different months.** **Sources:** AJ Sir = AJ Sir's lecture decks; Adhikari = Bikash Adhikari, *Organization and Management* slide notes; Joshi = S.K. Joshi, *Organization and Management*, A.K. Books.